



McAfee for President

The AntiVirus mogul plans to stand for elections in the US.

<http://dgit.in/PrezMcAfee>



Ringa Ringa iPhone

Watch what happens when an iPhone rings...around ants. Follow on here:

<http://dgit.in/AntPhone>

Feature

Since mobile applications have been the hot cakes lately, it wanted to be a part of this investigation and a company called 'Fairsearch' decided 'why not?'. Fairsearch filed a complaint against Google in 2013 over its android operating system on mobile phones thereby limiting market access of rival mobile operating systems. Doesn't this sound like a case of sour grapes? Then perhaps the entire premise of 'abusing dominant position' is a saga of how sour the grapes tasted to the fox occupying the unmentionable 'subservient' position.

These allegations were forwarded to Google Inc. in March 2013, to which Google, without any hesitation offered a settlement. It wrote off all allegations against itself and said it would bring about further transparency in its dealings, the degree of which could only be paralleled by Google itself. Given the U.S Federal Trade Commission's investigation it had recently dusted out of its way by a narrow margin on the similar grounds, transparency and honourable intentions seemed to be the call of the day.

Google's remedial measures

It submitted a 'Commitment' to the European Commission proposing certain standards of conduct it would follow in order to ensure that internet users would have the choice to choose someone else. Basically it decided to continue to make its presence felt but also decided to draw attention to the fact that it may be the granddaddy of search engines but there are others and it knows where you can find these 'others'. Google said it would guarantee that display of its own specialized search services and that of its rivals shall be in a comparable format.

What this means is that, whenever Google promotes one of its own super efficient specialised search services, there will be three rival services also displayed prominently on the page, in a way that is clearly visible to users. Also, not only will these rival services be 'present', they will also be pretty (Yay! to hell with beauty is only skin deep or that it is in the eyes of the beholder). For example, if Google uses a picture to promote its services (Psst: ultimate seduction technique), rival services will also be allowed such a picture.

Moreover, Google decided to stop copy pasting. It offered other service providers an 'opt out' in case they were no longer interested in being on the merry go around. Up until now, Google was able to copy content from rivals without restriction. Also, the opt out by a rival would not be held against it by Google while determining rankings.

Google also promised to remove exclusivity requirements in its agreements with its advertising and publishing partners and also remove restrictions on advertisers from running their search advertising campaigns across Google's and competing search advertising platforms.

This makes one wonder, whether Google is really playing devil or does the devil have fantastic advocates.

Google also offered a grand explanation of how rankings of rival links would be conducted. It has come up with a 'vertical sites pool' and has attempted to explain how exactly it intends to fish.



Google: "And then *sob* he said 'Did you mean...' "

That seems fair enough, right?

Bearing in mind this commitment and barking up one's logical side, doesn't 'promotion of own business' seem to lose merit as a contention? The largest revenue for Google is Adwords. Most other Google's operations (search, maps, Google drive, Chrome, YouTube, Translation, Google+, gmail etc) are in the nature of charity, so to say. Therefore the concept of making a profit on



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